



Part—I

Blender for Novices

The User Interface

Blender is a free, powerful and open source 3D graphics program, but it can be daunting for a beginner. Fear not! In this series, we will explore this wonderful tool, starting with the essential facts about Blender's user interface.

*R*leased under the GNU GPL, Blender is available for multiple operating systems, including Windows, Mac OS X and, of course, GNU/Linux. Blender has held the distinction of being fairly easy to master for experts and newbies alike, as compared to other confusing and complex proprietary 3D software.

Installing Blender

To follow the Let's Try, you will, of course, need to install the application. Though the

latest release of Blender is version 2.5 Alpha 2, for learning purposes I would recommend you choose version 2.49b, as it has the most extensive documentation, and is considered to be the most stable build so far. Most Linux distros ship with Blender, but if you are stuck with an older version, you may update it using your distro's package manager. If your OS does not ship Blender, head to <http://www.blender.org> to find a binary installation package for your operating system. Blender is available for many operating systems, including BSD, MorphOS